

Course Information Guide

Honors Physics

Zachary J. Rohrbach, Instructor
(317) 544-5000 x5472
ZJRohrbach@avon-schools.org

Course Description

Physics is the study of how the universe works on the most fundamental level. In this class, you will use your powers of observation and logical as well as mathematical reasoning to describe, explain, and predict the behavior of objects.

Course Goals As a result of taking Honors Physics I, you will:

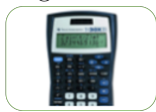
1. Know and understand the process that is used to make the scientific discoveries that are reported in the media or in the workplace
2. Understand the scientific principles that underlie motion, forces, waves, and electricity.
3. Apply your mathematical skills to solving real-world problems
4. Develop problem solving and scientific literacy skills

Required Materials

You are expected to bring the following materials with you to class every day.



Three-Ring Binder



Scientific Calculator



School Laptop



Charger

Methods of Evaluation

Your pre-exam grade will be based on the methods of evaluation shown below. The weighting of each of these categories is subject to change. Your overall class grade will consist of the pre-exam grade (85%) and the final exam grade (15%).

1. Homework (30%)
 - Homework plays an important role in helping you understand the material. Therefore, it is important that it gets done in a timely manner!
 - There will be multiple HW quizzes each unit based upon the problems you were to complete on the syllabus. They are also open-note! Therefore, it is to your advantage to bring to class your homework!
 - Homework is accepted for full credit until Test Day. There will be a 50% penalty for homework turned in after test day. Homework will not be accepted any later than the Test for the following unit.
2. Labs/Projects (30%)
 - Many labs will have an associated worksheet to turn in or a short summary paragraph to complete via Schoology.
 - A few labs will require a fully typed lab write-up to be uploaded to Schoology.
 - Late labs will be assessed a penalty of 10% per school day (whether or not class meets) up to 50%. Labs that are more than a month late will not be accepted.
 - There will be one research project in the Spring Semester. If you complete your research project late, it is immediately assessed a 50% penalty.
3. Tests (40%)
 - Each chapter will end with a quiz or a test. Equations for that unit will be provided.
 - Notes or other aids will not be accessible during the test.

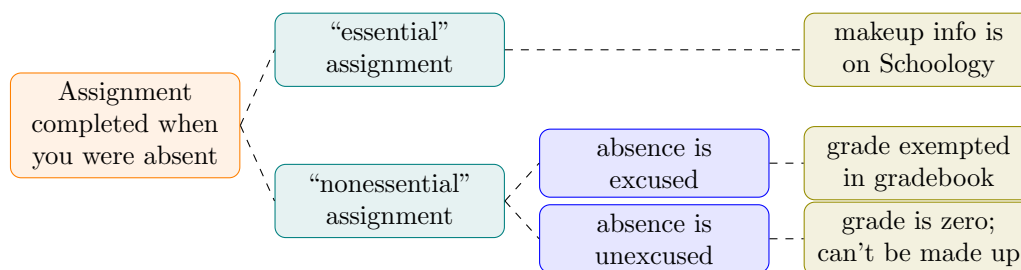
Class Policies

Tardies You are tardy if you are not in the classroom by the time the bell rings. In compliance with the AHS attendance policy, you will be given a detention on your 3rd and 4th tardies and referred to Saturday School for 5th and 6th tardies.

Cell Phones and Earbuds In compliance with the AHS Wireless Communication Device (WCD) Policy and Indiana Senate Enrolled Act 78, all phones, earbuds, and other WCD's should be powered off and inaccessible during the school day. Students found with any WCD will be sent to the office and have their device confiscated.

Absences and Makeup Work I will often post video explanations and recordings on Schoology for students who are absent. It is your responsibility to check Schoology and contact me with any questions.

There are some activities that we do in class which will not need to be made up. Students with *excused* absences will be exempted from these assignments in the grade book. Students with *unexcused* or *unverified* absences will receive a zero, which cannot be made up. This is in line with the policy in the AHS Student-Parent handbook: "If a student is absent from any class(es), even with the knowledge or consent of a parent/guardian, the student may not be permitted to make up work for credit for that day if the absence is unexcused."



Textbook We will be using the OpenStax *College Physics: 2nd Edition* online textbook. You will be expected to read material from the textbook in order to be prepared for class. You can access it for free at <https://openstax.org/details/books/college-physics-2e>. There are also a limited number of hard copies of this textbook that you can check out and take home.

Artificial Intelligence You are being evaluated on how well *you* can meet the course objectives, not on how well AI can do so. Here are some guidelines:

1. AI use is **entirely forbidden** on tests, quizzes and lab reports, because these assignments are designed to showcase your thinking and not a computer's thinking. AI use in these situations will be considered Academic Dishonesty and will result in a zero and a detention.
2. Using AI to help you prepare for a test by giving practice questions or explaining topics is permitted.
3. Using AI for hints on particularly difficult HW problems can be okay as long as you are using it *sparingly* to *aid in your own understanding*. If you use AI for help on your homework, ***you are required to indicate that you have done so***. For example, you can write, "ChatGPT helped me set up this problem," next to your work. Remember, you will need to be able to do problems on your own by the time you get to the test, so don't let yourself rely too heavily on AI.
4. Mr. Rohrbach is a better teacher than AI. If you find yourself relying on AI during homework, he would be happy to help you out during SRT, in class, or after school.

Contacting Mr. Rohrbach Parents and students should feel free to contact Mr Rohrbach at any time via email (ZJRohrbach@avon-schools.org), phone, ParentSquare, or Schoology.